

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Christmas time is here!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe personal and regional eating habits and cooking in a range of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Did you used to believe in Santa Claus?
- Would you leave him milk and cookies on Christmas eve?
- When did you stop believing in him?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about family traditions.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can talk about past habits.





Let's Explore!

Sally and her family always found **the perfect tree***.

* Many families in North America go to a lot or a farm to find the perfect Christmas tree.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Christmas has always been a magical time for me. The whole family would go together to find the perfect tree. Then we'd spend the afternoon decorating it while Mom baked dozens of cookies. Dad would unwrap the ornaments and pass them out to us. We used to find a special place for each one on the tree.

We all still have our old Christmas stockings. We used to hang them up, then put out milk and cookies for Santa.

In the morning, we'd wait on the stairs while Dad turned on the tree lights. Then we'd race down to open our gifts. We'd stuff ourselves with chocolates and candy canes while we unwrapped the gifts.

I've got an album of Christmas photos I took. I haven't looked at it for ages! I used to write a special Christmas story every year too. Dad has collected them over the years. He's having them made into a little book for me! Christmas memories are the best!





Let's Practice!

Sally remembers Christmases past.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the correct word. Use words from the words below.

Word Bank

put out / write / baked / stuff / unwrapped

1. Mom _____ thousand of cookies.
2. We always _____ milk and cookies for Santa.
3. We'd _____ ourselves with chocolates.
4. We ate candy canes while we _____ our gifts.
5. I'd _____ a special Christmas story every year.



Let's Practice!

Sally talks about her family's Christmas!

Instructions: Read the words. Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. go / family / the / tree. / perfect / whole / find / would / to / The / together
_____.
2. Dad / unwrap / and / to / us. / ornaments / them / the / pass / out / would
_____.
3. on / each / one / the / find / tree. / We / a / place / to / for / used / special
_____.



Extension Activity

Invite people to a holiday gathering!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make up an invitation to a holiday gathering.
- Say where and when you have decided to have the party.
- Say what traditional foods you have made.
- Read your invitation to a partner.
- Listen to your partner's invitation.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write an invitation.

☐ ☐

I say where I've decided to have the party.

☐ ☐

I talk about what food I've prepared.

☐ ☐

I read my invitation aloud.

☐ ☐

I listen to my partner's invitation.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- magic** (noun): special powers that make things happen
e.g. Christmas is a magic time for children.
- to decorate** (verb): to add something to a thing to make it attractive.
e.g. We would all decorate the tree together.
- to hang up** (verb): to put on a hook or nail
e.g. We hung up our Christmas stockings on the fireplace.
- ornament** (noun): a small decoration used on a Christmas tree
e.g. We put each ornament in a special place.
- Christmas stockings** (noun): special socks used to put small Christmas treats in
e.g. In the morning our Christmas stockings were full of candies!
- to pass out** (verb): to give one by one
e.g. Dad would pass out the ornaments.
- to stuff** (verb): to put inside until something is full
e.g. We would stuff ourselves with chocolates!
- candy cane** (noun): a red and white striped peppermint candy
e.g. We put candy canes in our hot chocolate to melt.
- Santa** (noun): Santa Claus; the man who gives children toys at Christmas
e.g. Santa left us lots of toys!





Learning Points

Used to and Would to Talk About Past Habits

Used to and **would** are both used to talk about past actions.

You use *used to* to say that something happened in the past but doesn't happen any more. It uses -ed to show past tense.

For example: I used to skate every winter.
(Before, I skated every winter, but now I don't skate.)

When we were children, we used to skate all day long.
(Before, we skated all day long, but now we don't skate all day long.)

We use *would* to talk about both past actions and past routines.

Would refers to actions, rather than situations.

Structure	Meaning
<i>I used to skate every winter.</i>	I skated every winter before before, but now I don't.
<i>When we were children, we used to skate all day long.</i>	Now we don't skate all day long.

Examples:

- *Did you used to visit Santa and have your picture taken with him when you were young?*
- *Does your family bring out the photo album and add to it each Christmas?*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the Present Perfect tense when the action has some relationship to now.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about completed actions.

Let's look at some other ways to compare these tenses.

Explanation	Example
The Present Perfect is used when the time period has NOT finished.	<i>I have never skated.</i> <i>(I still don't skate now)</i>
The Simple Past is used when the time HAS finished.	<i>I didn't skate when I was young.</i> <i>(I did not skate then)</i>
The Present Perfect is often used when giving recent news.	<i>I have bought new skates!</i>
The Simple Past is used when giving older information.	<i>I got some skates for my last birthday.</i>
The Present Perfect is used when the time is not specific.	<i>I've been to the Boston Common before.</i>
The Simple Past is used when the time is clear.	<i>I went to the Boston Common Last week.</i>

